

TAMER'S BOND

CORE RULEBOOK

A Fan-Made Digimon Tabletop RPG



Chapter 1: The World

Before you build a Tamer, before you choose a Digimon, you need to understand the world they live in. Tamer's Bond takes place across two worlds — and the line between them is thinner than most people think.

The Digital World

The Digital World is a realm that exists parallel to the human world, born from the flow of data that runs beneath modern civilization. It is vast, strange, and alive in ways that the human world is not. Mountains of crystal data rise and fall. Oceans of code stretch to horizons that shift when you are not looking. Entire regions can change overnight.

The Digital World Is Not Fixed

The Digital World can be reshaped by those with the power to do it. A powerful Digimon might tear up a mountain range and wind it into a single spiraling peak. A Tamer with deep enough knowledge of how the world's code works might open a doorway between two distant places, folding geography like paper. This is not magic. It is the nature of a world built from data — and it means that the world the party enters at the start of the campaign may look very different by the end of it. The GM decides what is possible and what has changed. The players decide what they do about it.

The Human World

The human world is wherever the campaign is set — a city, a country, a specific neighbourhood the GM has decided is the centre of this story. Unlike the Digital World, the human world follows rules that most people take for granted. It is stable. Predictable. It does not reshape itself because someone wanted it to.

Whether Digimon are a known and accepted part of human life — or a secret, a rumour, or a panic-inducing shock — is a decision the GM makes before the campaign begins.

Setting Question	What It Changes
Do humans know Digimon exist?	Affects every social interaction. A Digimon walking into a convenience store hits differently depending on the answer.
Can both worlds be crossed freely?	Determines how often the story shifts between worlds and how accessible the Digital World feels as a resource.
Do authorities know about Tamers?	Could turn the party into targets, assets, or somewhere in between.

Setting Question	What It Changes
How common are Digimon in daily life?	Shapes the tone — wonder and discovery vs normalised coexistence vs hidden threat.

Digimon

Digimon are digital lifeforms — creatures born from data, shaped by evolution, and driven by an instinct that runs deeper than hunger or territory. At their core, most Digimon want to grow stronger. Victory means growth. Defeat, in most cases, means reverting to a Digi-Egg and starting the climb again.

What a Digimon Wants	What That Looks Like in Play
To become the strongest	Seeks out powerful opponents. May challenge the party's Digimon directly — not out of malice but out of respect for the fight.
To protect something or someone	Territorial, cautious around strangers. Will fight without hesitation if that thing is threatened.
To evolve into a specific form	Has a long-term goal that shapes their decisions. May make surprising alliances to get there.
To live peacefully	Not interested in conflict — until conflict finds them. Then capable of surprising ferocity.
To understand humans	Curious, observant, possibly attached to a Tamer before either of them expected it.
Something entirely their own	Work with your GM. The Digital World is strange enough that almost any motivation fits.

Chapter 2: Overview

In Tamer's Bond, each player controls two characters — a Tamer and their Digimon partner. Both can fight. Digimon are the primary combatants but Tamers are not helpless. Every decision about how to grow your character, spend your Hope, and push your partner shapes every battle.

What You Need to Play

Players	One GM and 1–4 players
Dice	d4, d6, d8, d10, d12, d20, d100
Character Sheets	One for each Tamer and Digimon
Grid Map	For combat — 1 square = 1 space
Tokens	Miniatures or tokens for all participants

The Core Relationship

Every Tamer has six Crest Stats. These feed directly into their Digimon partner's combat stats. Raise your stats and your partner gets stronger alongside you.

Tamer Crest Stat	Feeds Into Digimon	What It Does in Combat	Notes
Courage	Courage (Hit Rate)	Governs hit chance. 1d20 + Courage vs Reliability+10.	
Friendship	Friendship (Speed)	Governs movement distance and turn order.	Digimon move Friendship spaces. Tamers move Friendship x2 spaces. Digimon turn order = Friendship. Tamer turn order = Friendship x2.
Love	Love (Damage Reduction)	Subtracted from incoming damage on every hit.	
Knowledge	Knowledge (Damage)	Primary damage bonus added to every attack.	
Sincerity	Sincerity (HP)	Determines total health pool.	
Reliability	Reliability (Miss Threshold)	Attackers must beat Reliability+10 to land a hit.	
Hope (derived)	Digivolution resource	Fuels digivolution. See Hope Pool table.	Not a combat stat.

UPDATED IN v0.6

Movement and Turn Order (v0.6): — Digimon move a number of spaces equal to their Friendship stat. — Tamers move a number of spaces equal to their Friendship stat x2. — Digimon turn order = Friendship (no multiplier). — Tamer turn order = Friendship x2. — Ties broken by the higher raw Friendship stat. — Tamers and Digimon have separate turns in initiative order.

Chapter 3: Creating Your Tamer

Building a Tamer takes five steps. Work through them in order. By the end you will have a complete character with 1,500 EXP to spend.

Starting EXP Budget

Every new Tamer begins with 1,500 EXP to spend at character creation. All six crest stats start at rank 1 for free. All 24 skills start at rank 1 for free. Hope pool = calculated from the Hope Pool table using your highest crest stat rank. Your Digimon also starts with 1,500 EXP in their own separate pool.

Step 1 — Who Are You?

Field	Description
Name	What do people call you?
Age	Most Tamers are 10–14. No hard rule.
Gender & Pronouns	How do you identify?
Appearance	What do people notice first?
Personality	Two or three words that sum you up.
Background	Where are you from? What was life like before?
Want	What does your character most deeply want at their core?
Fear	What do they most fear? Be specific.
Flaw	One honest weakness that will actually cause problems.
Crest	Which of the six crest stats defines you?

Step 2 — Crest Stats

Every Tamer begins with all six Crest Stats at rank 1 for free. Spend EXP to raise them. Stats cap at rank 10 over the full campaign.

Stat	Abbr.	Meaning
Courage	CRG	Physical ability, acting under pressure
Friendship	FRD	Social connection, reading others — also governs movement and turn order
Love	LVE	Awareness, empathy, protection
Knowledge	KNW	Tech, tactics, Digital World logic
Sincerity	SNC	Core self, constitution, resistance
Reliability	RLB	Protection, preparation, healing

Upgrade	EXP Cost	Running Total
Rank 1 → 2	200	200
Rank 2 → 3	300	500
Rank 3 → 4	400	900
Rank 4 → 5	500	1,400
Rank 5 → 6	600	2,000
Rank 6 → 7	700	2,700

Upgrade	EXP Cost	Running Total
Rank 7 → 8	800	3,500
Rank 8 → 9	900	4,400
Rank 9 → 10	1,000	5,400

Hope

Hope is not one of the six crest stats. It is derived automatically from your highest crest stat rank using the table below.

Hope Pool

Hope Pool is determined by your highest crest stat rank. Rank 1 = 5 Rank 2 = 10 Rank 3 = 20 Rank 4 = 35 Rank 5 = 55 Rank 6 = 80 Rank 7 = 105 Rank 8 = 130 Rank 9 = 165 Rank 10 = 200 Hope regenerates fully between sessions and after a long rest. Hope is spent at the start of YOUR TURN in combat to maintain digivolution.

Tamer HP

Tamer HP is derived from Sincerity rank: $HP = 12 + (Sincerity\ rank \times 4)$. Rank 1 = 16 HP. Rank 10 = 52 HP.

UPDATED IN v0.6

Tamer HP Formula (v0.6): $12 + (Sincerity\ rank \times 4)$ Previously: $8 + (Sincerity\ rank \times 3)$. Updated to give Tamers more survivability.

Step 3 — Skills

Every skill begins at rank 1 for free. Skills are cheaper to raise than stats but capped by their parent stat. There are 24 skills.

The Stat Cap Rule

A skill rank can NEVER exceed its parent crest stat rank. If Friendship is rank 3, no Friendship skill can exceed rank 3. Raise the stat first.

Skill	Stat	Description
Blitz	Courage	Explosive speed and agility, vaulting, sprinting
Ironclad	Courage	Pushing through exhaustion and harsh conditions
Crusher	Courage	Raw force, breaking barriers, overpowering obstacles
Ghost	Courage	Moving unseen, vanishing into shadows, tailing targets

Skill	Stat	Description
Roar	Courage	Projecting dominance, making others hesitate or break
Scan	Friendship	Reading people like data, sensing deception
Rally	Friendship	Getting someone on your side through reason or charm
Broadcast	Friendship	Commanding attention, moving an audience
Mend	Love	Calming someone in distress, offering care that reaches them
Radar	Love	Noticing fine details, reading a room, sensing danger early
Tame	Love	Connecting with Digimon or wild creatures without words
Decode	Knowledge	Breaking down problems, finding the flaw in any system
Jack In	Knowledge	Digital intrusion, breaching firewalls, hijacking networks
Modify	Knowledge	Building, repairing, improvising devices from parts
Trace	Knowledge	Following trails, piecing together evidence
Archive	Knowledge	Deep knowledge of the Digital World, Digimon history and lore
Command	Knowledge	Reading a battle, calling plays, coordinating allies
Playback	Knowledge	Pulling precise facts from memory
Firewall	Sincerity	Blocking mental attacks, dark auras, psychological pressure
Reinforce	Sincerity	Enduring physical damage and punishment
Core Drive	Sincerity	Refusing to give up when everything is falling apart
Zero Error	Reliability	Staying precise and controlled under pressure
Field Ops	Reliability	Surviving and navigating the Digital World's hostile terrain

Skill	Stat	Description
Recovery	Reliability	Treating injuries, getting downed allies back on their feet

Step 4 — Classes

Classes are special abilities beyond raw stats and skills. Any Tamer can take any class if they meet the requirements. Classes cost EXP from the same pool as stats and skills. Each module introduces its own class trees.

Step 5 — Your Partner

Work with your GM to select a Digivolution line. See Chapter 4: Building Your Digimon to complete your partner's sheet.

Chapter 4: Building Your Digimon

Your Digimon partner is a full character in their own right. They have their own crest stats, their own EXP pool, their own personality, and their own history.

The Six Digimon Crest Stats

Digimon use the same six crest stats as Tamers. A Digimon's stat total is built from four layers stacked together.

The Four Layer System

Every Digimon crest stat = Species Base + Tamer Rank + Digimon Invested + Conditional Species Base — Set by the Digimon's species and current evolution stage. Changes on evolution. Tamer Rank — The Tamer's crest stat rank for that stat is added directly. Digimon Invested — EXP spent from the Digimon's own pool. Never resets on evolution. Conditional — Temporary buffs and debuffs. Cleared at end of each encounter. Example: Agumon's Courage. Species Base = 4. Tamer's Courage rank = 3. Digimon invested = 2. Total Courage = 9.

Digimon HP

Digimon HP Formula

Digimon Max HP = 20 + (total Sincerity x 4) Total Sincerity = Species Base + Tamer Sincerity rank + Digimon Invested Sincerity + Conditional Example: Total Sincerity = 8. Max HP = 20 + (8 x 4) = 52 HP.

UPDATED IN v0.6

Digimon HP Formula (v0.6): 20 + (total Sincerity x 4) Previously: 10 + (total Sincerity x 2). Updated to significantly increase survivability and reduce one-shot kills.

Digimon EXP Pool

The Digimon has their own separate EXP pool that always mirrors the Tamer's total EXP earned. Spending EXP on the Digimon does NOT affect the Tamer's pool and vice versa.

Raising Digimon Stats

Upgrade	EXP Cost
0 → 1	100 EXP
1 → 2	200 EXP
2 → 3	300 EXP
3 → 4	400 EXP
And so on...	Rank x 100 EXP per step

Digivolution Form Unlocks

Stage	Min Digimon EXP	First Form	Each Additional Form
Rookie	Free	Free	50 EXP per form
Champion	2,000 EXP	FREE	100 EXP per form
Ultimate	8,000 EXP	FREE	300 EXP per form
Mega	20,000 EXP	FREE	500 EXP per form

Digivolution Path Rule

When digivolving, a Digimon can only digivolve into a form that their current stage can actually digivolve into. If a form is unlocked from a different digivolution line, the Digimon cannot use it unless their current form has a valid digivolution path to it — even if that form is in their known pool. Example: If Agumon has Garurumon unlocked via an alternate path, Agumon cannot digivolve into Garurumon because Agumon does not digivolve into Garurumon. The path must be valid for the current form.

Move Pool

Move Pool Rules

Every Digimon has 4 active move slots: 1 Signature Move — locked to current stage, auto-updates on digivolution 3 Learned Moves — chosen from the pool at long rest, stay until next long rest The pool grows as the Digimon reaches new stages. Each new stage adds that stage's signature move permanently. **STAGE LOCK:** A pool move can only be used at the stage it was learned or higher. **IN-TRAINING:** All Digimon have Bubble Blow as their In-Training signature move. PR1, Neutral element, no tags.

Chapter 5: Growth & Experience

There are no levels in Tamer's Bond. Characters grow by spending EXP. Every purchase is a tradeoff.

Earning EXP

Event	EXP Reward	Notes
Short or light session	75–150	Mostly roleplay, travel, or downtime
Standard session	200–400	A mix of combat, exploration, and story
Heavy or climactic session	400–600	Boss fights, major revelations, high stakes
Story milestone	500–1,000	Defeating a major villain, finding a crest, arc resolution
Personal character moment	100–300	Awarded individually for standout roleplay or growth

How EXP Pools Work

Tamers and Digimon each have their OWN separate EXP pool — they do not share one pool. Both pools always contain the same total EXP earned. Example: The GM awards 350 EXP. The Tamer's pool gains 350. The Digimon's pool ALSO gains 350 independently. Spending EXP on the Tamer does NOT reduce the Digimon's pool and vice versa.

Campaign Pacing

Campaign Stage	Approx. Total EXP	Expected State
Session 1 (creation)	1,500	Stats at 1–2, a few skills at 2–3, clearly defined but fragile
Season 1 midpoint	8,000–10,000	Primary stat pushing rank 4–5, core skills at 3–4
Season 1 end	15,000–20,000	Primary stat at 5–6, secondary stats 3–4, first classes purchased
Season 2 end	35,000–45,000	Primary stat pushing rank 8, skills nearing rank 5
Full completion	~70,000+	All stats and skills maxed, all desired classes purchased

Chapter 6: Combat

Combat takes place on a grid where 1 square = 1 space. Both Tamers and Digimon take their own separate turns in initiative order. Digimon are the primary fighters but Tamers can fight too.

Adjacent

Adjacent means any of the 8 squares surrounding a character's space — including diagonals. This applies to all [MELEE] moves and any ability that references adjacency.

The Round Structure

Each round of combat follows this order:

- Determine Turn Order — Digimon use Friendship (no multiplier). Tamers use Friendship x2. Highest acts first. Ties broken by higher raw Friendship stat.
- Each Character Takes Their Turn — In initiative order, each Tamer and each Digimon takes their full turn before the next character acts.
- Resolution Stage — CHARGE moves fire. Status effects tick. Lingering conditions resolve.

UPDATED IN v0.6

Turn Order (v0.6): — Digimon initiative = Friendship stat (no multiplier). — Tamer initiative = Friendship stat x2. — A Tamer with Friendship rank 3 has initiative 6. Their Digimon has initiative 3. — Tamers and Digimon always act on separate turns, even in the same round.

Actions on Your Turn

Action Commitment Rule

Once a character begins an action, they must finish it before starting another. Movement cannot be split around other actions. If you move, you complete your movement before taking a Basic Action. You may choose the order of your Move Action and Basic Action, but each must be completed before the other begins.

Action Type	What It Covers	Limit
Move Action	Move up to your speed in spaces (Digimon = Friendship, Tamer = Friendship x2).	Once per round
Basic Action	The main thing you do — attacking, digivolving, using an item, or a special action.	Once per round
Free Action	Minor things that take no meaningful time. Some can be used off-turn.	Once per round*
Second Move	Spend Basic Action to take a second Move Action this turn — move again up to your full speed.	Once per round

On a Tamer's Turn

At the start of each Tamer's turn — not the start of the round — deduct the Hope cost for their Digimon's current digivolution stage. If Hope hits 0 the Digimon immediately reverts to Default Stage before any actions.

Basic Action	How It Works
Attack	Use one of your moves against a target. Follows the full attack sequence.
Digivolve	Attempt to digivolve your partner. Costs your Basic Action for the turn.
Use Item	Use a carried item. Effect depends on the item.
Skill Check	Make any relevant skill check the situation calls for.
Push Through	Restore Hope equal to a relevant skill roll result. Once per encounter only. See below.
Taunt	Make a Roar check DN 12. On success, draw enemy attention. See below.
Second Move	Take a second Move Action — move again up to your full Friendship x2 spaces.

Push Through — Basic Action, once per encounter

The Tamer digs deep and recovers Hope through willpower alone. Make a skill roll using any relevant skill (GM discretion — Recovery, Core Drive, and Reinforce are common choices). Restore Hope equal to the roll result. This Hope goes only to the Tamer who used the action. Can only be used once per encounter. Cannot be used if the Tamer's Hope is already at maximum.

Taunt — Basic Action

The Tamer draws enemy attention to protect their Digimon or allies. Make a Roar skill check (DN 12). On a success, the target enemy will redirect their attacks toward this Tamer instead of Digimon — provided it is physically possible for them to do so after their movement this turn. The enemy may still move freely before attacking. Possibility is determined after movement resolves. If multiple Tamers successfully Taunt the same target in the same round, the last Tamer to succeed is the target. Taunt lasts until the start of the taunting Tamer's next turn or until the Tamer is incapacitated.

Free Action	Effect	Off-Turn?
Call Out	Your partner gains +1 to their next attack roll this round.	No — your turn only
Analyze	Archive check DN 12. Identify one piece of information about an enemy.	No — your turn only
Dedigivolve (1 stage)	Voluntarily drop your Digimon one stage. Hope cost adjusts before being spent this turn.	No — your turn only

Free Action	Effect	Off-Turn?
Dedigivolve (2 stages)	Spend your Free Action to drop your Digimon two stages at once. Hope adjusts before being spent.	No — your turn only

On a Digimon's Turn

Digimon act on their own turn in initiative order, separate from their Tamer.

Basic Action	How It Works
Attack	Use one of your four active moves against a target.
Second Move	Spend Basic Action to take a second Move Action this turn.

Free Action	Effect	Off-Turn?
Dedigivolve (1 stage)	The Digimon voluntarily drops one stage. Hope adjusts before being spent on the Tamer's next turn.	No — Digimon's turn only
Dedigivolve (2 stages)	The Digimon drops two stages at once. Hope adjusts to new stage before next Tamer turn.	No — Digimon's turn only

Dedigivolution Clarification

Both the Tamer AND the Digimon can each trigger a voluntary dedigivolution on their own turn using their Free Action. They cannot both dedigivolve in the same round — each can only use their own Free Action once. Maximum voluntary dedigivolution per turn: 2 stages (if either the Tamer or Digimon uses the two-stage option). Status effects are always cleared on any digivolution or dedigivolution, voluntary or forced.

Making an Attack — Step by Step

Step 1 — Select Target and Move

Choose the target and which of your four active moves you are using. The move must be usable at your current stage. Check the move's tags for range or area restrictions. Remember: once you begin your movement, complete it before taking your Basic Action.

Step 2 — Determine Hit or Miss

Hit Formula

Roll: 1d20 + Attacker's total Courage stat Target: Defender's total Reliability stat + 10 Meet or beat the target number = HIT Fall short = MISS — attack ends here, no damage

Roll Result	Effect
Natural 20	CRITICAL HIT — automatic hit. Double the final damage result after all calculations.
Natural 1	CRITICAL FAIL — automatic miss. Attack ends immediately. No damage.

Step 3 — Determine Damage

Damage Formula

Damage = PR dice + Attacker's total Knowledge - Defender's total Love PR dice: determined by the move's Power Rating (see Chapter 7: Moves) Minimum damage before multipliers: 1

Step 4 — Apply Weakness or Strength

Apply attribute and element multipliers. Calculate attribute first then multiply by element.

Attacker Attribute	Defender Attribute	Multiplier
Vaccine	Virus	x2.0 advantage
Virus	Data	x2.0 advantage
Data	Vaccine	x2.0 advantage
Vaccine	Data	x0.5 disadvantage
Data	Virus	x0.5 disadvantage
Virus	Vaccine	x0.5 disadvantage
Free	Any	x1.0 always neutral
Unknown	Any	x2.0 beats all attributes

Element	Resistant To	Weak To
Fire	Fire (x0.5)	Water, Earth (x1.5)
Water	Water (x0.5)	Electric, Plant (x1.5)
Plant	Plant (x0.5)	Fire, Wind (x1.5)
Electric	Electric (x0.5)	Earth, Wind (x1.5)
Wind	Wind (x0.5)	Electric, Fire (x1.5)
Earth	Earth (x0.5)	Water, Plant (x1.5)
Light	Light (x0.5)	Dark (x1.5)
Dark	Dark (x0.5)	Light (x1.5)
Neutral	Nothing	Nothing — always x1.0

Chapter 7: Moves

A Digimon does not simply attack — it expresses itself. Every move is a piece of their history, a technique carried forward from every stage of their evolution.

The Basic Attack

Basic Attack

Element: Neutral PR: 2 (1d6) Tag: [MELEE] Available to: All Tamers and Digimon at all times. The Basic Attack works exactly like any other attack — it follows the full attack sequence using the normal hit roll, damage formula, and all applicable multipliers. It does not occupy any of the four active move slots. It is simply always there. Because it has [MELEE], the attacker must be adjacent (one of the 8 surrounding squares) to their target.

Power Rating (PR) Dice Table

PR	Dice	Avg	Typical Stage
1	1d4	2.5	In-Training
2	1d6	3.5	Rookie weak
3	1d8	4.5	Rookie standard
4	1d10	5.5	Rookie strong
5	1d12	6.5	Champion weak
6	2d6	7	Champion standard
7	2d8	9	Champion strong
8	2d10	11	Ultimate weak
9	2d12	13	Ultimate standard
10	3d8	13.5	Ultimate strong / Mega weak
11	3d10	16.5	Mega standard
12	3d12	19.5	Mega strong
13	4d10	22	Mega II standard
14	4d12	26	Mega II strong
15	5d10	27.5	Mega II signature (maximum)

Mega II — Stage Note

Mega II is not a separate mechanical stage. In all rules, Mega II Digimon are treated as Mega stage. Some Mega-stage Digimon are simply able to digivolve into another Mega-stage form. The PR 13–15 range exists to represent these top-tier forms without changing how the stage rules work. Fresh-stage Digimon have no moves and no PR — they are narrative only.

Move Tags

Delivery Tags

Tag	Effect
[MELEE]	Must be adjacent (any of the 8 surrounding squares) to the target to use this move.
[RANGE X]	Can hit targets up to X spaces away.
[PIERCE]	Ignores the target's Love stat damage reduction entirely.
[TRUE]	Cannot miss if the hit roll succeeds. A natural 1 still misses.

Area Tags

Tag	Effect
[BURST X]	Hits all enemies within X spaces of the ATTACKER. Roll damage once and apply to all targets.
[BLAST X]	Hits all enemies within X spaces of the TARGET. Roll damage once and apply to all targets.
[CHAIN X,Y]	Bounces from the primary target to X additional targets each within Y spaces. Each subsequent target takes half the damage of the previous.

Timing Tags

Tag	Effect
[CHARGE]	Costs your Basic Action this turn. The move fires at the Resolution Stage at the end of the round. You may still move normally.
[COUNTER]	Can only be used as a Free Action immediately after this character was attacked — only if they have not used their Free Action this round.

Tag	Effect
[RUSH]	Does not consume your Move Action. Move up to your full speed (Digimon = Friendship spaces, Tamer = Friendship x2 spaces) and attack at any point during that movement. You may still take your Move Action separately before or after using RUSH.

Status Effect Tags

Tag	Rules
[BURN X,Y]	On hit, target gains a Burn stack. X = damage taken at start of target's turn. Y = number of ticks. If hit with BURN again: take the higher X value and add the Y counters together.
[FREEZE]	Target cannot act. At end of their turn roll 1d20 + total Love vs DN 14 to break. Also breaks immediately if the target takes any damage.
[PARALYZE X]	Target's Speed is halved. X = stacks. At start of target's turn lose 1 stack. 1–3 stacks: choose Basic OR Move Action. 4+ stacks: cannot act. Natural 20 on any roll clears all stacks.
[BLIND]	Target suffers -4 to all attack hit rolls for the duration.
[CONFUSE]	At start of the target's turn, roll 1d20 + total Friendship vs DN 14. Fail = must attack the closest ally.
[DRAIN]	On hit, the attacker regains HP equal to half the damage dealt (round down, minimum 1).
[PUSH]	On hit, push the target away. Spaces pushed = Attacker's Courage minus Defender's Courage. Minimum 1 space.
[POISON X]	On a natural attack roll of 15 or higher, the target is Poisoned with X stacks. If already Poisoned, add X to their current Poison total. At the start of their turn the target takes damage equal to their current Poison stacks. Poison does not tick down — it must be cured or cleared by digivolving or dedigivolving.
[SLEEP]	Target cannot act. At the start of their turn they make a Firewall skill check DN 13 — on a success they wake and may act normally this turn. They also wake immediately if they take any damage.

NEW IN v0.6

Sleep (v0.6) — [SLEEP]: A new status effect added in this version. Target cannot act while asleep. Two ways to wake up: 1. At the start of their turn make a Firewall skill check DN 13. Success = awake, acts normally this turn. 2. Taking any damage immediately wakes the target — they may act normally on their next turn. Unlike Freeze, Sleep uses Firewall (mental resistance) rather than Love (physical endurance). Status Effect Clearing on Digivolution / Dedigivolution: ALL active status effects — including Poison and Sleep — are immediately cleared whenever a Digimon digivolves or dedigivolves, voluntarily or otherwise.

Chapter 8: Digivolution

Digivolution is not a button you press. It is a question your partner asks of you — do you have enough left? Every evolution is paid for in Hope, and Hope is not infinite.

Stages

Stage	Notes
Fresh	No stats, no moves. Narrative only.
In-Training	All base stats = 1. PR 1 signature move only.
Rookie	Starting stage for all new partners. PR 2–4.
Champion	First major digivolution milestone. PR 5–7.
Ultimate	Mid-campaign goal. PR 8–10.
Mega	Campaign endgame target. PR 10–12. Some Mega Digimon can digivolve into another Mega form (PR 13–15).

Hope — Digivolution Fuel

Hope Pool

Quick reference: Rank 1=5 | Rank 3=20 | Rank 5=55 | Rank 7=105 | Rank 10=200 Hope regenerates fully between sessions and after a long rest.

Stage	Hope Cost Per Turn
In-Training	1
Rookie	3
Champion	6
Ultimate	10
Mega	15

Stacking Costs

When digivolved multiple stages above Default Stage, pay the SUM of all stage costs above Default. Example: Default = Rookie, Current = Ultimate Cost = Champion (6) + Ultimate (10) = 16 Hope per Tamer turn

Digivolving on Your Turn

Digivolution happens on the Tamer's turn and costs the Tamer's Basic Action. You can only digivolve one stage at a time unless a class ability states otherwise. You cannot digivolve more than 2 stages above your current Default Stage.

Digivolution Path Rule

A Digimon can only digivolve into a form that their current stage can digivolve into. Having a form unlocked in your pool is not enough — the current form must have a valid evolutionary path to the target. If a Rookie has two Champion forms unlocked but can only reach one of them from its current species line, only the reachable form is available for digivolution.

Status Effects Clear on Digivolution

When a Digimon digivolves to a higher stage, ALL active status effects on that Digimon are immediately cleared. This applies to voluntary digivolution and forced digivolution alike.

Voluntary Dedigivolution

A Tamer or Digimon may choose to dedigivolve voluntarily on their turn using their Free Action. Key summary:

- One stage: Free Action — Digimon drops one stage. Hope cost updates before being spent.
- Two stages: Free Action — Digimon drops two stages. Hope cost updates before being spent.
- Only one of the two (Tamer or Digimon) may use their dedigivolve Free Action per round.
- Status effects are cleared on any dedigivolution.

Forcing a Digivolution

You can spend less than the full Hope cost to digivolve. The less you spend, the higher the number you need to roll on d100 to avoid corruption. Out of combat you must always pay the full Hope cost — forcing is not allowed outside of battle.

How Forcing Works

When you spend less than the full stage cost, roll d100. Roll ABOVE the threshold for a clean digivolution. Threshold formula: $(1 - \text{Hope Spent} / \text{Full Cost}) \times \text{Stage Danger}$ Stage Danger values: Rookie 20 | Champion 35 | Ultimate 55 | Mega 80

HP on Digivolution

Action	HP Rule
Digivolving up	Current HP increases by the difference between old and new max HP.
Dedigivolving	Current HP is capped at the new lower max HP.
Out-of-combat healing	Valid strategy — digivolve up then dedigivolve to bank HP gain. Must pay full Hope cost. No forcing out of combat.

Hitting 0 HP — The Cascade

Situation	What Happens
Above Default Stage	Revert to Default Stage at 1 HP. Still in the fight.
At Default Stage	Default Stage drops by 1. Remain at 1 HP.
Overkill hit (>50% max HP)	Default Stage drops by 1 additionally. Stacks with the above.
Egg state	If Default Stage cannot drop further, become an egg. Out until next session.

Corrupted Digivolution

When a forced digivolution roll fails the Digimon evolves into a corrupted form. The GM chooses which form emerges.

Corruption Rules

NO HOPE COST — the corrupted form maintains itself with no per-turn cost. **NO EARLY REVERSION** — stays corrupted until the encounter ends. **GM CONTROLLED** — attacks the closest Digimon or Tamer, prefers type advantage targets. **MOVE STAYS** — the corrupt form's signature move is permanently added to the pool. Encounter ends when: all enemies defeated, corrupted Digimon defeated, or all others submit.

Daily Rest Recovery

After each full day of rest, if the Digimon's Default Stage is below their Max Default Stage, it increases by one. Default Stage cannot exceed Max Default Stage through any means.

Chapter 9: Defeat, Victory & Tamer Conditions

Loss is part of Digimon. If every encounter is won the characters never grow. If every encounter is lost the story stalls. The rules here handle both ends.

Winning an Encounter

An encounter is won when all opposing forces are defeated, driven off, or choose to submit. The GM declares the encounter over. All conditional stat modifiers clear. Corruption ends. The party may rest, loot, or press on.

Losing an Encounter

What Losing Looks Like

An encounter is lost when all Digimon have reverted to egg state and all Tamers are at 0 HP — or when the party chooses to submit. The GM determines what happens next. The enemy may capture them, leave them, or simply move on. EXP is still awarded after a lost encounter. The party learned something — even if it was only how strong the enemy really is.

Tamer HP and Defeat

Situation	What Happens
Tamer reaches 0 HP	The Tamer cannot take any actions for the remainder of the encounter. They are still present but cannot attack, use items, digivolve their partner, or make skill checks.
Encounter ends	The Tamer's HP is set to 1. They may act again but are in a Weakened State until they take a long rest.
Weakened State	The Tamer takes -2 to all rolls until they complete a long rest.

Total Party Defeat

Total Party Defeat Rules

The GM decides what happens next — capture, retreat by the enemy, intervention by an NPC, or something else entirely. All Digimon remain in egg state until the next session or until a class ability intervenes. All Tamers recover to 1 HP and enter the Weakened State after the encounter resolves. EXP is still awarded for the session. Defeat is not a punishment — it is a turning point. The story continues. What the party does next is up to them.

Chapter 10: Resting, Sessions & Encounters

What Is a Session?

A session is the period of time between two long rests. It begins when the characters wake from a long rest and ends when they take the next one. Food must be eaten once per session to avoid hunger debuffs. Some class abilities reset per session. EXP rewards are calculated and awarded at the end of a session.

What Is an Encounter?

An encounter is a defined period of dramatic activity within a session. A fight, a dangerous puzzle, a tense negotiation, or any situation where the GM calls for structured turns and meaningful stakes. Corruption clears at the end of each encounter. Conditional stat modifiers clear at the end of each encounter.

Short Rest — 15 to 30 Minutes

The Tamer makes a Recovery skill check. Both Tamer and Digimon restore HP equal to the result. Cannot exceed max HP. Does not restore Hope. Learned move slots stay fixed.

Long Rest — 8 to 10 Hours

Must include actual sleep — cannot be spent traveling or in combat.

After a long rest:

HP fully restored for both Tamer and Digimon Hope fully restored Digimon not at Max Default Stage may advance Default Stage by 1 The Digimon's player may rearrange their 3 learned move slots Eating counts during this time

Food & Rations

Both Tamers and Digimon need to eat once per day. Both must eat independently.

Food Status	Effect on Hope Pool
Well fed	Normal — no penalty
Hungry (missed 1 meal)	Hope pool halved
Starving (missed 2 meals)	Hope pool quartered
Desperate (missed 3 meals)	Hope pool reduced to one eighth

Chapter 11: Items

Items are objects Tamers and Digimon carry, equip, and use. Some are found as loot. Others are purchased with DigiDollars or real world money.

Type	Rules
DIGIVICE	One equipped at a time. Required for digivolution.
CLOTHING	One outfit equipped at a time. Worn by the Tamer. Passive — effect always active.
ACCESSORY	One equipped at a time. Worn items like necklaces, tags, and bags. Passive — effect always active.

Type	Rules
EQUIPMENT	Carried gear with active mechanical effects. No equip limit. Using equipment costs a Basic Action unless stated otherwise.
SUPPLY	Consumable items used up on use. No carry limit. Using a supply costs a Basic Action unless stated otherwise.
FOOD	Consumable meals. Eating costs no action — happens naturally during rest or downtime.

Core Items

The following items are available in all campaigns regardless of module.

Bandages

Type: Supply Cost: 50 DD / 10 Real World Money Effect: Restore 4 HP to one target. Can be used on Tamers or Digimon.

First Aid Kit

Type: Supply Cost: 80 Real World Money Effect: Restore 10 HP to one target and remove one status effect. Can only be used outside of combat. Contains 3 uses before it is empty.

Antidote

Type: Supply Cost: 150 DD / 30 Real World Money Effect: Remove all Burn, Paralyze, Poison, and Sleep from one target immediately.

Goggles

Type: Clothing Cost: 10 Real World Money Effect: +1 to all Radar skill rolls while equipped.

Hiking Gear

Type: Clothing Cost: 80 Real World Money Effect: +1 to all Field Ops skill rolls while equipped.

Compass

Type: Equipment Cost: 50 Real World Money / 100 DD Effect: +2 to all Field Ops skill rolls involving navigation. In the Digital World the GM may rule it behaves strangely.

Digi-Ration

Type: Food Cost: 30 DD — Digital World merchants Effect: Counts as a meal for both Tamer and Digimon. Prevents hunger. No bonus beyond preventing the penalty.

Onigiri

Type: Food Cost: 20 Real World Money / 60 DD Effect: Counts as a meal for the Tamer. Prevents hunger. Restores 6 HP on top of any other healing.

Noodle Bowl

Type: Food Cost: 40 Real World Money / 120 DD Effect: Counts as a meal for the Tamer. Prevents hunger. Grants +1 to all skill rolls for the current session.

Appendix: Quick Reference

Combat At a Glance

Rule	Summary
Turn order	Digimon = Friendship. Tamers = Friendship x2. Ties broken by higher raw Friendship. Separate turns for Tamers and Digimon.
Movement	Digimon move Friendship spaces. Tamers move Friendship x2 spaces.
Adjacent	Any of the 8 squares surrounding a character's space (includes diagonals).
Action commitment	Begin an action, finish it. Movement cannot be split around other actions.
Second Move	Spend Basic Action to take a second Move Action this turn.
Hope cost timing	Start of TAMER'S TURN — not start of round. 0 Hope = revert to Default Stage.
Voluntary Dedigivolve	Free Action on Tamer or Digimon's turn. 1 or 2 stages. Hope adjusts before being spent. Status effects clear.
Push Through	Basic Action, once per encounter. Restore Hope = relevant skill roll result. Self only.
Taunt	Basic Action. Roar check DN 12. On success, enemy redirects to Tamer if possible after movement.
Analyze	Free Action. Archive check DN 12. Learn one enemy trait.
Hit roll	1d20 + attacker's Courage vs defender's Reliability + 10
Natural 1	Auto miss — no exceptions
Natural 20	Auto hit + double final damage
Damage	PR dice + attacker's Knowledge - defender's Love. Min 1 before multipliers.
Multipliers	Attribute first, then element. Max x3.0. Min x0.25. Always min 1 final damage.
Active moves	4 total — 1 locked signature + 3 learned (set at long rest)

Rule	Summary
Call Out	Free Action — partner gets +1 to next attack roll this round
Status on digivolution	ALL status effects (including Poison and Sleep) are cleared on any digivolution or dedigivolution.

Status Effects At a Glance

Status	How to Wake / Clear	Source Tag
Burn X,Y	Ticks down Y times at start of turn, then clears	[BURN X,Y]
Freeze	1d20 + Love vs DN 14 at end of turn, or take damage	[FREEZE]
Paralyze X	Lose 1 stack at start of turn. Natural 20 clears all.	[PARALYZE X]
Blind	Duration based — see move description	[BLIND]
Confuse	1d20 + Friendship vs DN 14 at start of turn	[CONFUSE]
Poison X	Item, ability, or digivolve/dedigivolve only	[POISON X]
Sleep	Firewall check DN 13 at start of turn, or take damage	[SLEEP]

HP Formulas

Character	Formula	Rank 1 Example	Rank 5 Example	Rank 10 Example
Digimon	$20 + (\text{total Sincerity} \times 4)$	Sincerity 4 = 36 HP	Sincerity 12 = 68 HP	Sincerity 20 = 100 HP
Tamer	$12 + (\text{Sincerity rank} \times 4)$	Rank 1 = 16 HP	Rank 5 = 32 HP	Rank 10 = 52 HP

Hope Pool Quick Reference

Highest Crest Stat Rank	Hope Pool
Rank 1	5
Rank 2	10
Rank 3	20
Rank 4	35

Highest Crest Stat Rank	Hope Pool
Rank 5	55
Rank 6	80
Rank 7	105
Rank 8	130
Rank 9	165
Rank 10	200

Digivolution At a Glance

Rule	Summary
Hope pool	See Hope Pool table — highest crest stat rank determines pool size
Stage limit	Max 2 stages above Default Stage
Digivolution path	Must follow a valid species path. Unlocked forms on different lines are not accessible from an incompatible current form.
Rookie extra forms	First Rookie form free. Each additional Rookie form costs 50 EXP.
Forced digivolution	Roll d100 — fall in corruption range = corrupt form
0 HP at Default Stage	Default Stage drops by 1
Overkill (>50% max HP)	Default Stage drops an additional 1
Daily rest	Default Stage +1 up to Max Default Stage

Resting At a Glance

Rest Type	Duration	Effect
Short rest	15–30 minutes	Recovery check restores HP to both. No Hope. Learned moves stay fixed.
Long rest	8–10 hours	Full HP and Hope restored. Default Stage +1 if below max. Learned moves can be rearranged.
Missed meal	Once per day	Hope pool halved (stacks to 1/4, then 1/8). Affects Tamer and Digimon separately.

CREDITS

Tamer's Bond — Core Rulebook

Creator

& Lead Designer punisher355.mo System design, rules writing, campaign development, and playtesting.

Digimon Statistics

& Foundry VTT Development Lewis Created a large portion of the Digimon species stat blocks, built and maintains the Foundry VTT JSON files, and contributed extensively to the game's Digimon data infrastructure. Also a playtester.

Playtesters

punisher355.mo Lewis Dark Dragon Leonizard Thank you for your time, your feedback, and your willingness to break things so they could be built better.

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CREDITS

TAMER'S BOND — Core Rulebook

CREATOR & LEAD DESIGNER

punisher355.mo

System design, rules writing, all five season modules, campaign development, and playtesting.

DIGIMON STATISTICS & FOUNDRY VTT DEVELOPMENT

Lewis

Created a large portion of the Digimon species stat blocks, built and maintains the Foundry VTT JSON files, and contributed extensively to the game's Digimon data infrastructure. Also a playtester.

PLAYTESTERS

punisher355.mo · Lewis · Dark Dragon · Leonizard

Thank you for your time, your feedback, and your willingness to break things so they could be built better.

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This document is a playtest draft. Numbers are subject to change after testing.